Running a project

The workflow, step by step — and who may do what

Shah Investors Home Limited

A project in workPulse is governance, not scheduling. It records who answers for the work, what was committed, what could stop it, what has been decided and by whom — and reports its own health from those facts rather than from a status update somebody typed.

The final section lists every action on a project against the roles permitted to take it. It is generated by reading the application's own API, so it cannot drift from what is enforced.

WHAT IS IN HERE

The whole picture — one diagram

SETTING UP

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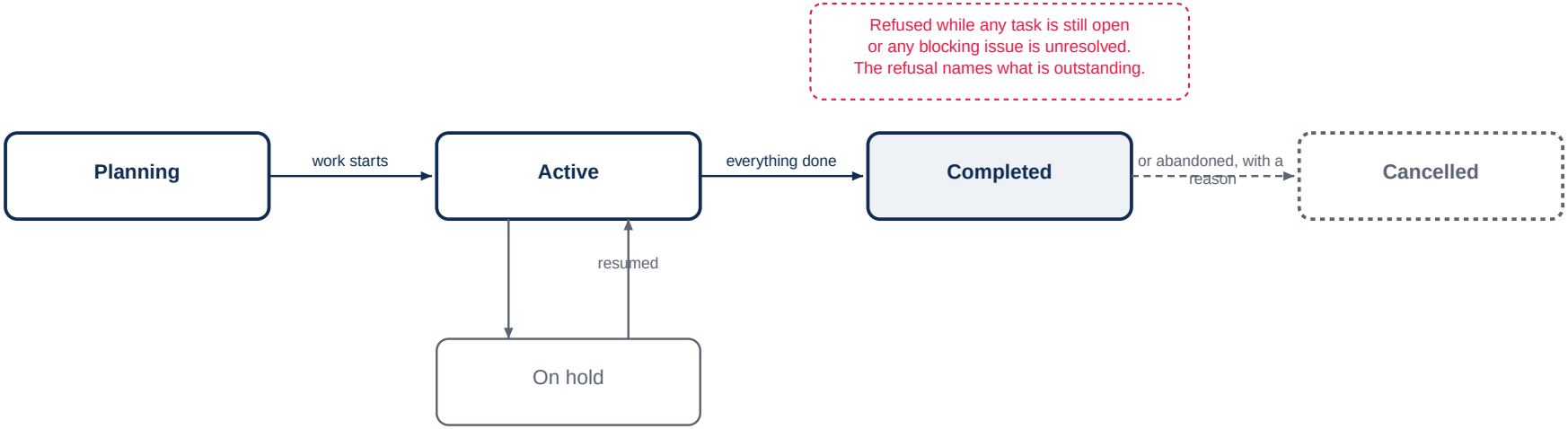
WHO MAY DO WHAT

Every action, against the roles that may take it

THE WHOLE PICTURE

A project, and the light that reports it

A project moves through four states. What makes it different from a list of tasks is the traffic light underneath: it is computed from three facts about the work, not typed in by whoever writes the status report.



HOW THE LIGHT IS DECIDED



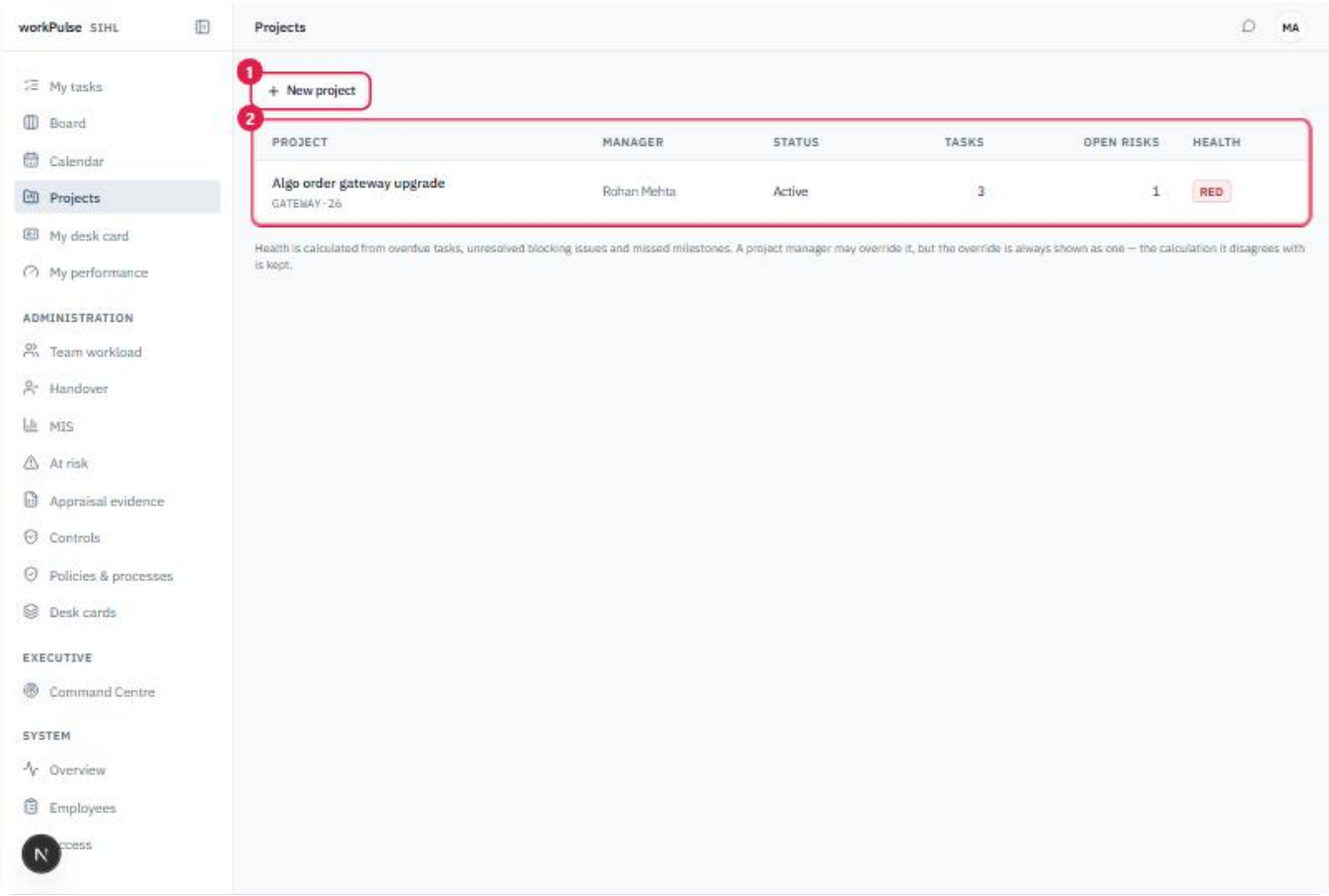
A missed milestone turns a project red on its own, whatever the task arithmetic says — a date that was promised and passed is not offset by a tidy percentage. A project manager may override the computed value, but the override is always shown as an override, with the reason and the figure it replaced beside it.

Screens here were captured on 18-19 October. The interface has moved on in one visible way since: the sidebar has gained SLA targets. Everything else in these pictures still matches the application.

SETTING UP

1. The register

Every project in one list, with the column that matters on the right. A project is a bounded body of cross-functional work with its own accountability — as opposed to a desk card, which is the standing duties of a seat and never finishes.

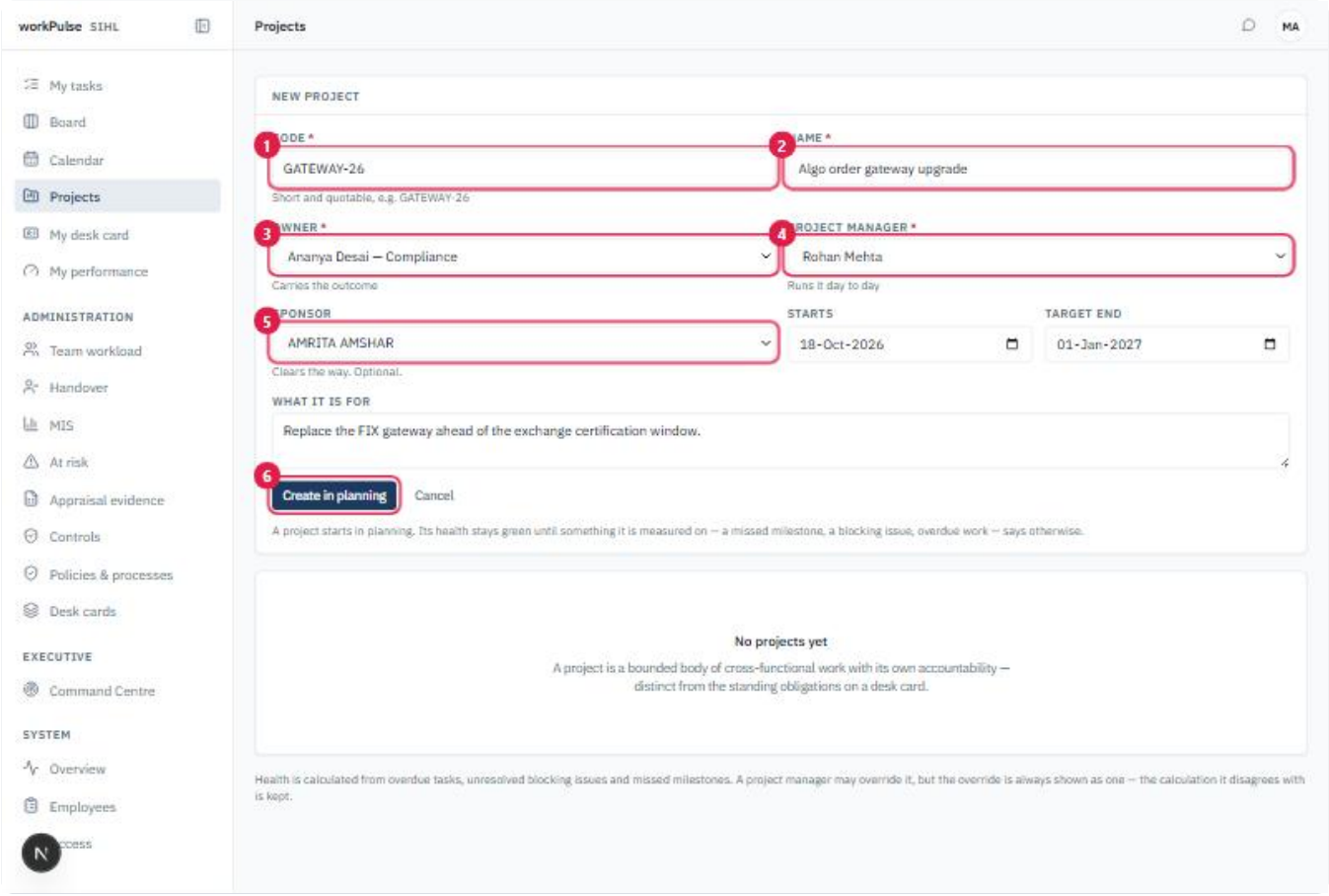


1. Start one. Project manager or above.
2. The register. Health here is computed, not reported — which is why it can disagree with the person running the project.

SETTING UP

2. Starting one

Three people are asked for separately because they are three different jobs. One person may hold more than one, but the form does not assume it.

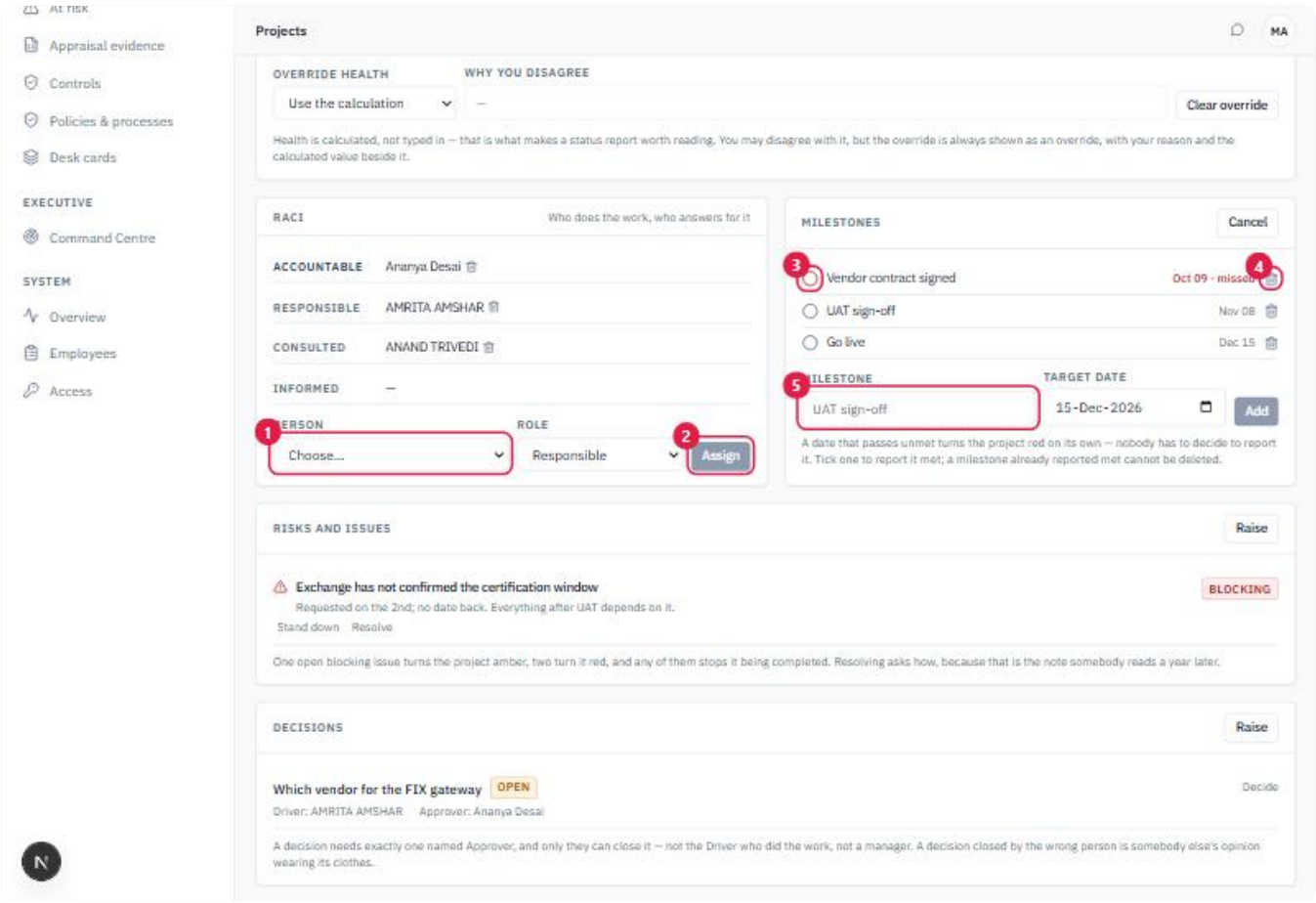


1. A short code you can quote in a steering pack.
2. What it is called.
3. Owner — carries the outcome.
4. Project manager — runs it day to day.
5. Sponsor — clears the way. Optional, and usually the answer to “who do I escalate to”.
6. Creates it in planning, where it reports nothing until there is something in it.

SETTING UP

3. Who answers for it, and what is due

RACI on the left, milestones on the right. Both feed how the project reports itself, and both are where a project quietly goes wrong if nobody fills them in.



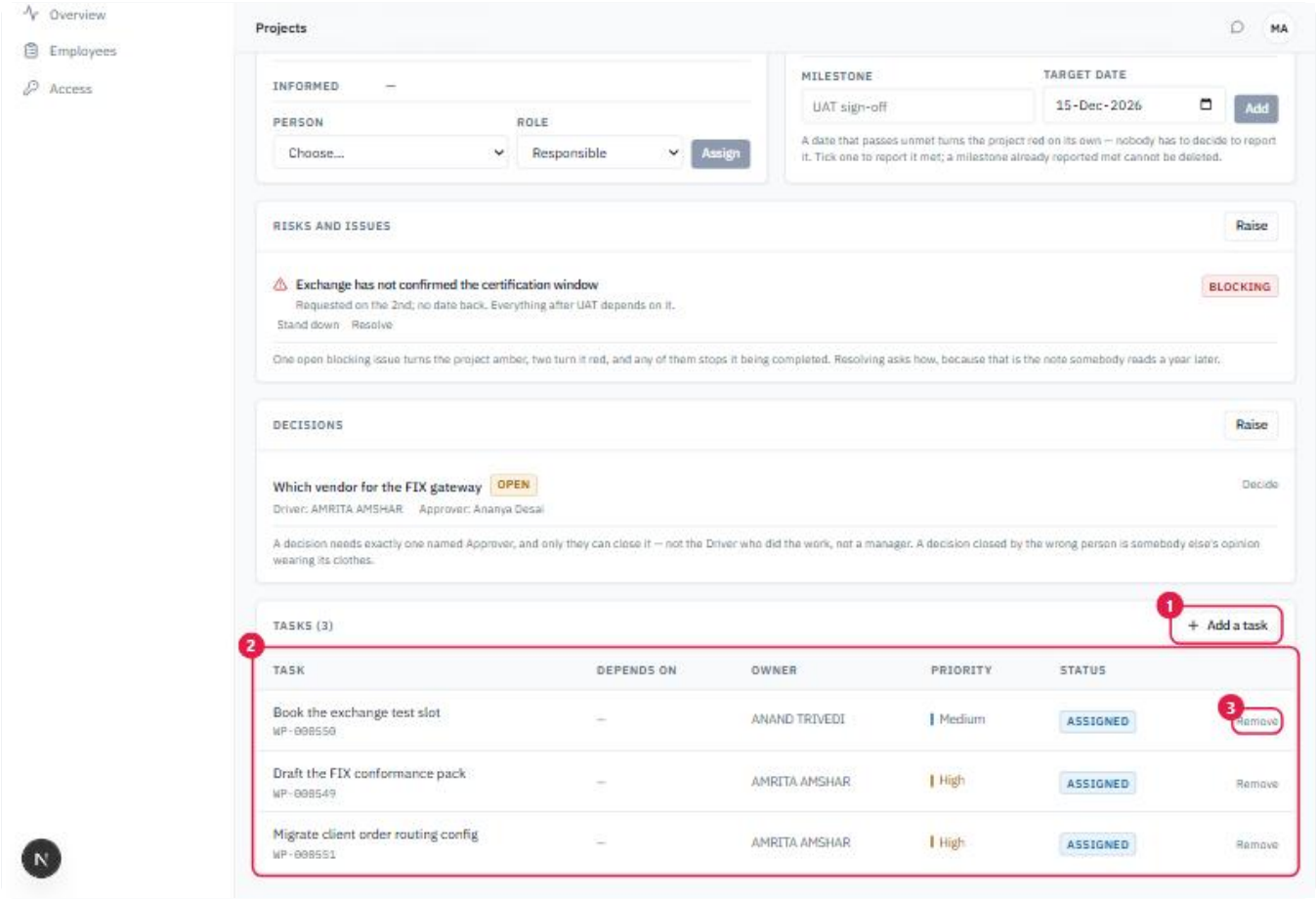
1. Add somebody and give them a role. Exactly one person is Accountable at a time; assigning a second asks you to confirm the replacement rather than displacing them silently.
2. Assign.
3. Tick a milestone to report it met — the date it was met is recorded, not just the fact.
4. Delete one that was never real. One already reported met cannot be deleted; re-open it first if that was wrong.
5. Add a milestone: a name and the date it is committed for.

A project with no milestones reads green however late it is. That is not a flaw in the light — it is the absence of anything to measure against.

RUNNING IT

4. The work that counts towards it

Tasks are not created inside a project. They are ordinary tasks — somebody's work, with the same lifecycle, reviewer and evidence rules — and the project link says which body of work they count towards.



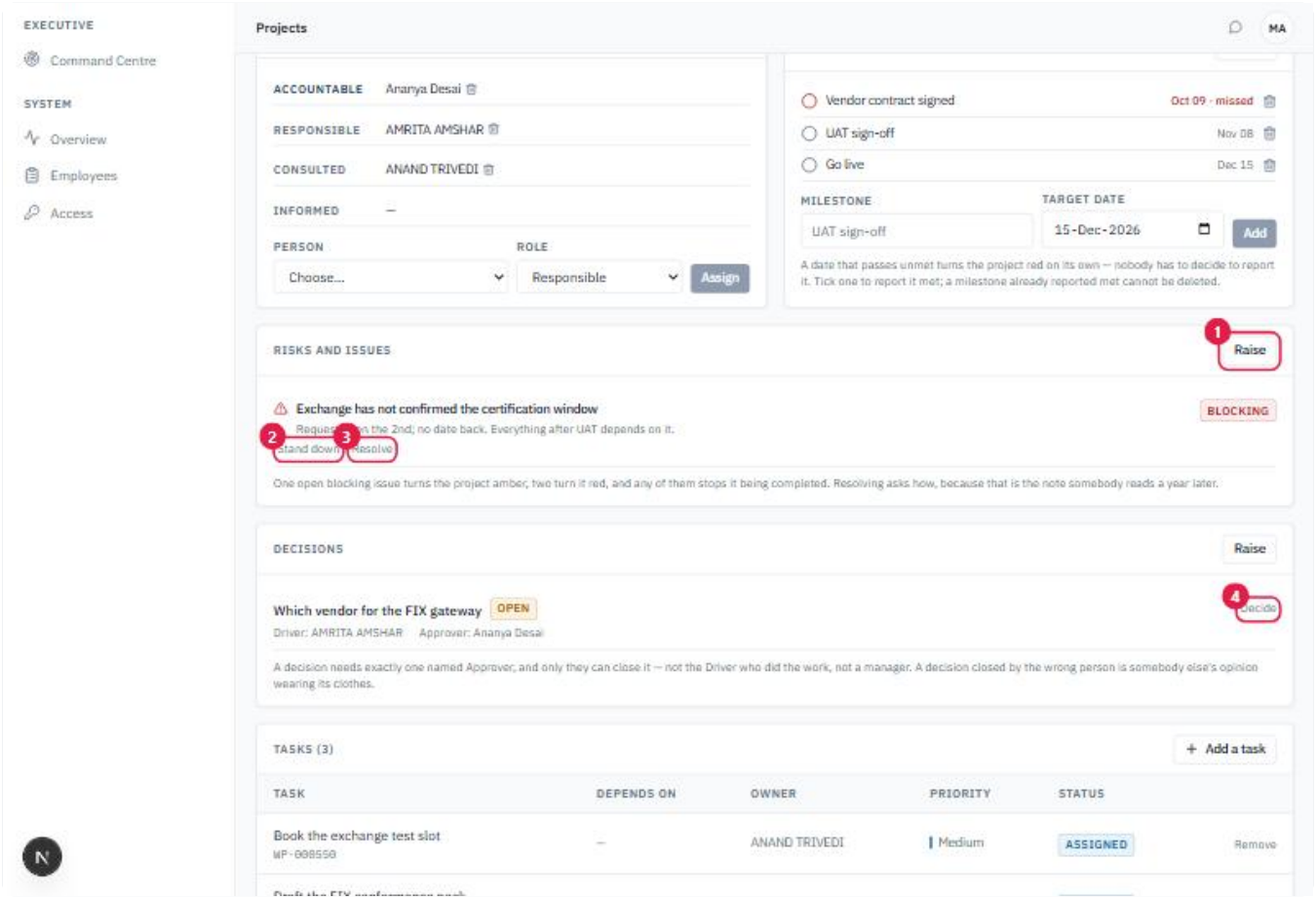
1. Add a task. Only tasks not already in a project are offered: a task counts towards one project, or none.
2. The project's work, with dependencies, owner, priority and status.
3. Take one out, with a reason — the project's figures change when it leaves.

> *This is where “33% of tasks are overdue” comes from. Each task still runs the full lifecycle of its own, covered in the companion guide.*

RUNNING IT

5. Risks, issues and decisions

Two different things, deliberately kept apart. A risk is something that could go wrong and is somebody's job to chase. A decision is a question that needs an answer from a named person.

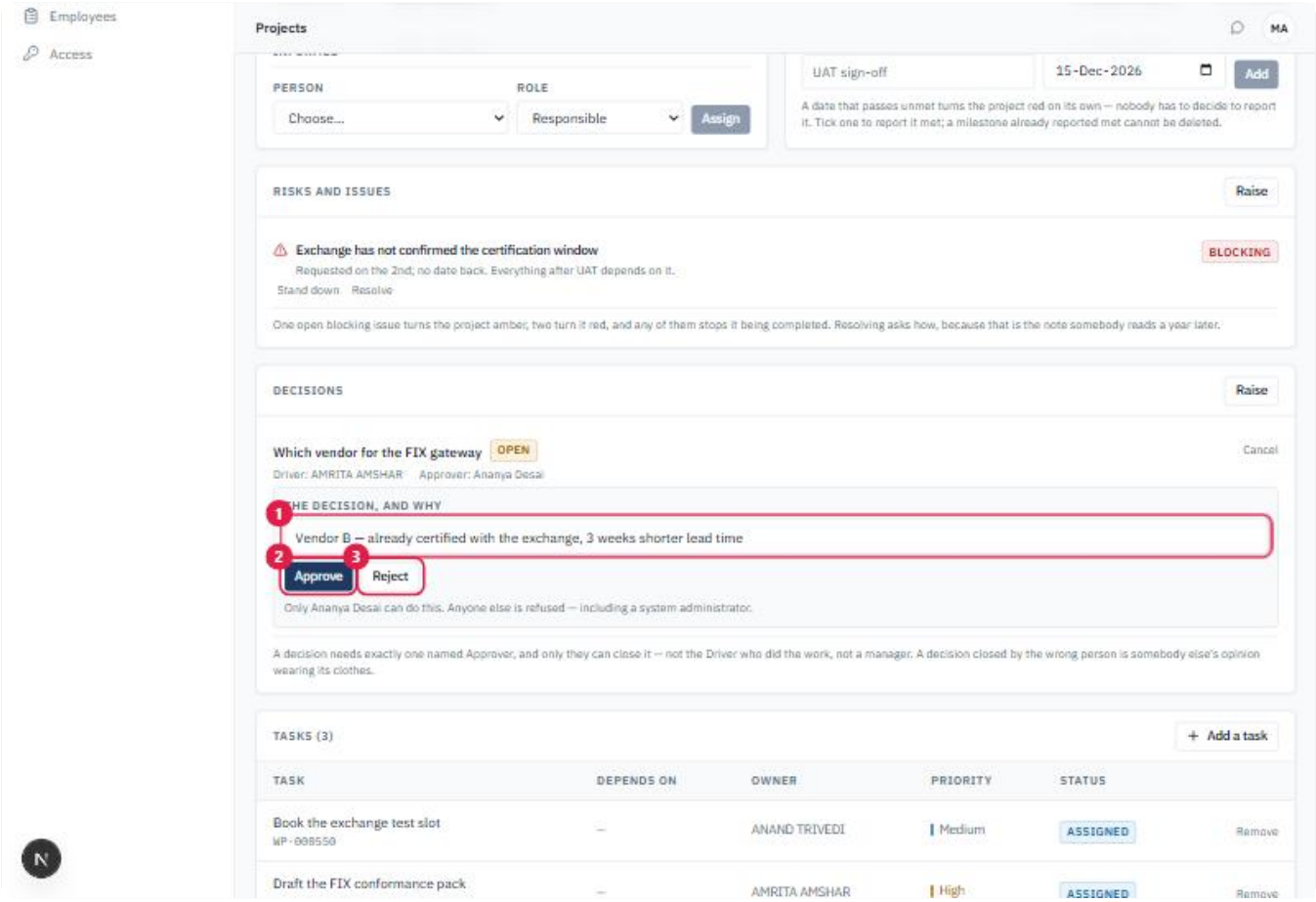


1. Raise a risk. Tick blocking if the project genuinely cannot finish until it is resolved.
2. Stand it down or escalate it — always with a reason, because blocking stops the project closing.
3. Resolve it. You are asked how, not just that.
4. Decide an open decision.

RUNNING IT

6. A decision has exactly one Approver

Decisions use DACI: a Driver who does the work of deciding, and an Approver who signs it off. The sign-off is the part that is enforced.



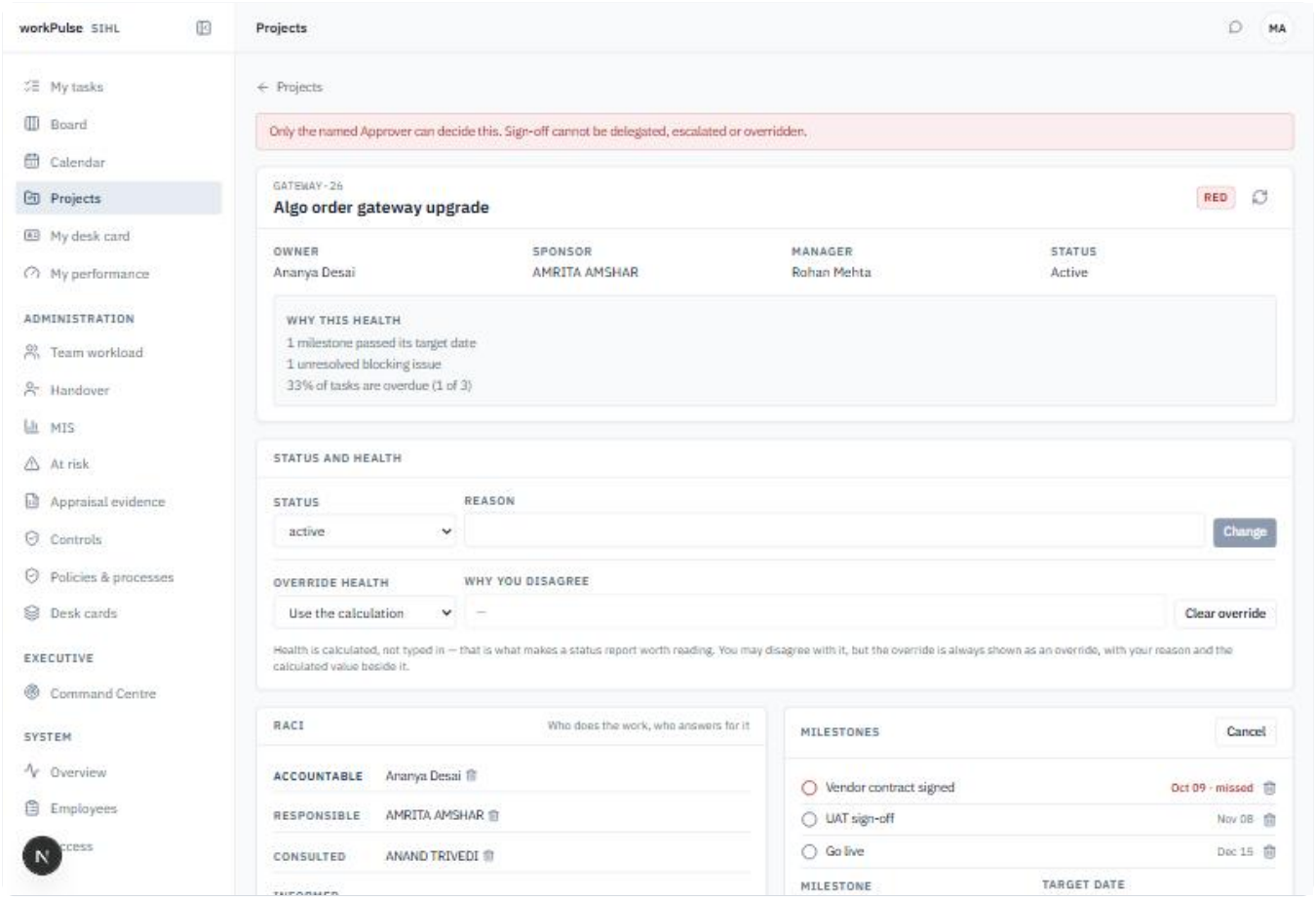
1. What was decided, and why — recorded with the decision, so the reasoning survives the meeting.
2. Approve.
3. Reject — also recorded, with the reasoning.

> *The screen names who may do it. The button is offered to everybody because a clear refusal teaches the rule better than a greyed-out control with no explanation.*

RUNNING IT

7. Not even an administrator

This is a system administrator — the most privileged role there is — being refused a decision sign-off.



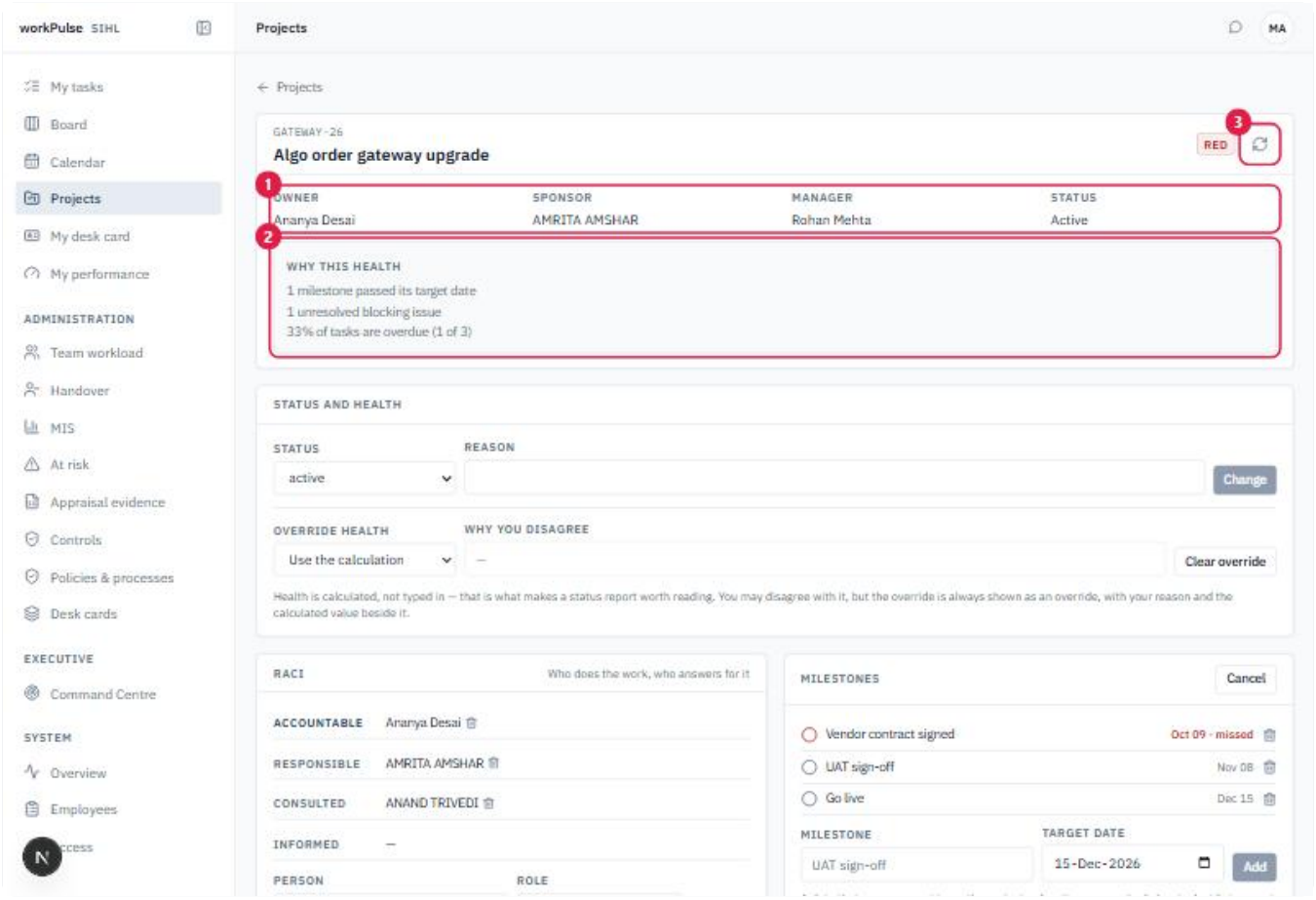
1 “Sign-off cannot be delegated, escalated or overridden.” Not by the Driver who did the work, not by a manager, not by an administrator.

A decision closed by the wrong person is not a decision; it is somebody else's opinion wearing its clothes. If the Approver is unavailable, change the Approver — and that change is itself recorded.

REPORTING

8. Reading the project

The top of the screen answers the four questions a steering meeting opens with, and then explains its own traffic light.



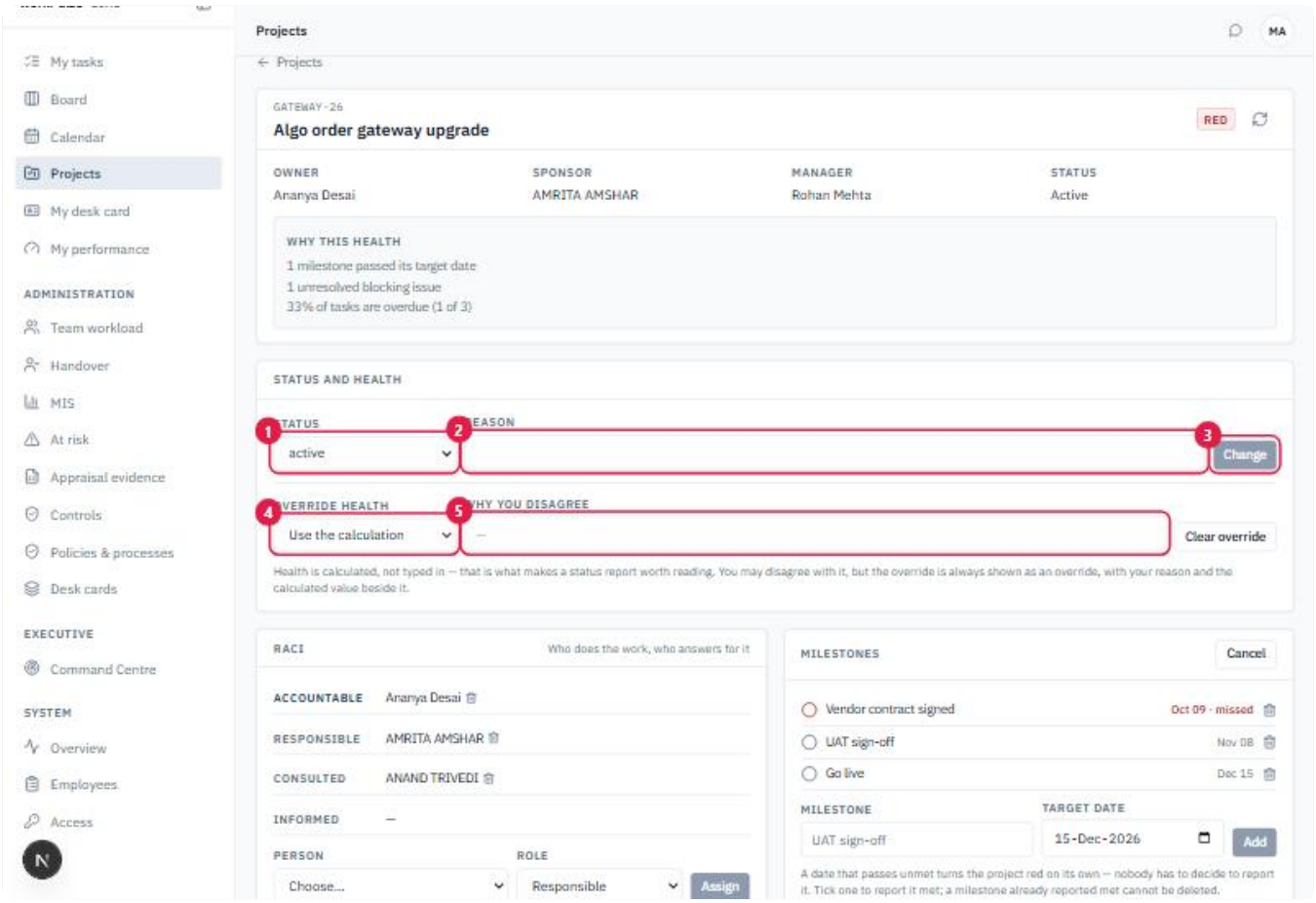
1. Owner, sponsor, manager, status.
2. Why this health, in plain words. A light nobody can interrogate gets argued with; one that explains itself gets acted on.
3. Recalculate, if you have just changed something and want the figure now.

> *Health is recomputed automatically whenever a milestone, risk or task changes. The button is for impatience, not correctness.*

REPORTING

9. Status, and disagreeing with the figure

Moving a project between states is a recorded act with a reason, and completion is refused while anything is outstanding.



1. The status.
2. Why it is moving.
3. Apply it.
4. Override the health if you genuinely disagree with the calculation.
5. Why you disagree — required, and shown wherever the override is.

WHO MAY DO WHAT

Every action, against the roles

Read out of the application's own API. Anybody signed in can look at a project; changing one needs a role. Where a rule is stricter than the role gate, it is noted — the gate decides who may attempt the action, the rule decides whether it succeeds.

ACTION	ROLES
Open the project register	Anyone signed in
Open a project	Anyone signed in
Start a project	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Move it through planning, active, on hold, completed	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Recalculate the health figure	Anyone signed in *Read-only — it only recomputes from existing facts*
Override the health figure	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *A reason is required and the override is always shown as one*
Add a milestone	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Report a milestone met, or re-open it	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Delete a milestone	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *Refused once it has been reported met*
Raise a risk or issue	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Escalate it to blocking, or stand it down	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *A reason is required*
Resolve it	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *A note saying how is required*
Put a task into the project	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Take a task back out	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *A reason is required*
Set or change RACI	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *Exactly one Accountable; replacing them is explicit*
Remove a RACI assignment	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager**
Raise a decision	**System admin · Dept head · Project mgr · Manager** *Exactly one named Approver*
Close a decision	Anyone signed in *ONLY the named Approver — see page 8*
Link one task to another	Anyone signed in *Cycles are refused*

Reading a project is open to everybody signed in, deliberately: a project nobody outside it can see is a project nobody can hold to account. Audit and the executive roles read everything; they change nothing here.